But things were not set to happen as he would have expected. Badiuz Zaman Mīrzā and Shah Shuja Beg attacked him suddenly. Fortunately, Sulṭān Masud Mīrzā had just joined him that day, and the army, which was sent out to put down Muhammad. Sulṭān Husayn Bayqara Mīrzā remained undefeated.

With all that happened, Sulṭān Husayn had grown a soft corner for Sulṭān Masud Mīrzā and later would end up becoming his son-in-law.

But things were not set to remain that sweet for long. Sulṭān Masud Mīrzā was instigated by Baqi Chaghantanif and the former went on to join hands with Khusrau Shah.

Khusrau Shah had begun to grow stronger with Baysonqor Mīrzā already by his side. Miran Shah Mīrzā, son of Aulugh Beg Mīrzā too had joined hands with Khusrau on the pretext of Hazara's rebellion against his father.

Many were looking to kill these three Tīmūrid Mīrzās. Perhaps, they thought that they would become a thorn in the way of Khusrau although he, himself did not think likewise.

## Babur Takes on Samarkand

It was the month of Shawwal in AD 1496. The news of the rebellion reached Babur in Andijān. Babur set his men on the horse to fulfil his desire to get Samarkand. Even Sulṭān Masud Mīrzā shared Babur's desire. The retirement of Sulṭān Husayn had added more vigour to Masud's vision. To reinforce Sulṭān Masud came Khusrau Shah and sent across his younger brother Wali.

As a strategy, Babur along with two other Mīrzā brothers beleaguered the town from three sides. They remained in position for around three to four months. Sulṭān Ali Mīrzā sent Khwaja Yahya to mediate an agreement, forming a common aim. Accordingly, an interview was arranged. Babur moved below the town with his forces from Sughd. On the other side, Sulṭān Ali Mīrzā brought his forces to the other side of the bank. Babur crossed the water of Kohik (known as the Zarafshan River today). Babur and Ali saw five men on each one's side. According to Babur, nothing much